

Philosophy

DocsForge exists because we believe documentation should be **as easy as possible**.

The problem

Modern docs tools require too much setup. What should be "write Markdown, get a website" often becomes:

- Configure 10+ Markdown extensions
- Install a theme separately
- Add plugins one by one
- Set up CDN scripts for math
- Configure client-side JS for syntax highlighting
- Debug why something broke after an update

Our principles

1. Zero config for core features

Everything you need works without configuration.

Write `$$...$$` → math renders. Write `!!! note` → admonition appears. Write ````python` → code highlights. All 31 Markdown extensions and 7 plugins are loaded by default.

You configure only what you want to customize, not what you need to exist.

2. Self-contained

After `pip install docsforge`, you own everything.

The theme, all plugins, all extensions, KaTeX, fonts, and Pygments are bundled inside the package. External assets are fetched during the build; readers make no CDN calls. Works offline.

3. Stable

Your docs build the same way in 10 years.

Because everything is vendored in the package, version-pinning the package pins the entire toolchain. No transitive dependency surprises.

4. Material quality

DocsForge is Material for MkDocs, made simpler.

We didn't reinvent the theme. We took the world's most popular documentation theme and made it work without configuration. You get the same professional look, the same responsive layout, the same dark mode — just without the setup.

What we removed

Feature	Why removed
<code>typeset</code>	Users can write Unicode directly
<code>optimize</code>	Requires external <code>pngquant</code> binary
<code>social</code>	Requires Pillow + CairoSVG
<code>projects</code>	Niche multi-project feature
<code>offline</code>	Privacy plugin covers most use cases
<code>group</code>	Plugin orchestrator (niche)

What we changed

Before (Material/MkDocs)	After (DocsForge)
Config file <code>docsforge.yml</code>	<code>docsforge.yml</code>
Theme via <code>mkdocs.themes</code>	<code>docsforge.themes</code>
Manually list all extensions	31 loaded by default
Manually list all plugins	7 loaded by default

Before (Material/MkDocs)	After (DocsForge)
<code>extra_javascript</code> for KaTeX	KaTeX vendored, zero config
Client-side JS for highlighting	Pygments at build time

Our goal

`pip install docsforge`, write Markdown, done.

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